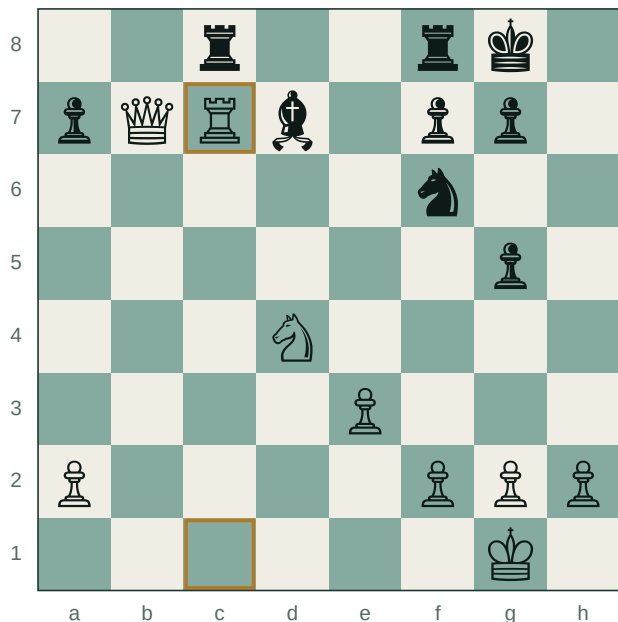


Clearance tactics: Black, move 26

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Rc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Rxc7 27. Qxc7 Rc8 28. Qxc8+ Bxc8

26...Rxc7 The rook captures the rook on c7. Recorded reply: **27.Qxc7**.

27...Rc8 The rook moves from f8 to c8. Recorded reply: **28.Qxc8+**.

28...Bxc8 The bishop captures the queen on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.